

Your Essay Analysis

Your Essay Graded

● Purpose (P) ● Coherence (C) ● Language Use (L) ● Mechanics (M)

Marking Scheme Explained

P - Purpose: Clear understanding and engagement with the purpose and audience of the task.

C - Coherence: Logical structure, clear progression of ideas, and effective organization.

L - Language Use: Suitability of tone, style, varied vocabulary, and effective expression.

M - Mechanics: Punctuation, spelling, syntax, and technical accuracy.

Question

Write a speech for or against the motion: "Social-media influencers are best left ignored"

Your Answer Analysis

Chairperson, adjudicators, members of the opposition, ladies and gentlemen, I would like to begin with a quote from Abhijit Naskar: "There is no such thing as social media, there is only unsocial media." Among the realms of social media influencers, we seem obstinate in our beliefs that these "influencers" have our best interests in mind, and that they are, indeed, not worth ignoring. Why is it that, while the opposition are living in a fantasy world of their own creation, we are steeped in reality and acknowledge that these people, safeguarded by silicon and algorithms, are not incentivised to be "social" whatsoever? My name is Matas Roda, and on behalf of the Beech Hill College debate team, we unapologetically oppose the motion that social-media influencers are best ignored.

Good use of a quotation to engage the audience.

The introduction is clear and engaging, but it could briefly outline the main points you will cover.

"steeped in reality" is a nice phrase.

Good intro, but state your 3 main points.

Firstly, it is worth noting what these influencers are influenced by. Not by social change, but profit — and the opposition is conflating the two incessantly! From cradle to grave, we are bombarded by people on the Internet and social media platforms selling us weight loss pills, unattainable lifestyles and pointless trinkets! In fact, a meta-analysis report from Stanford estimates that the average Gen Z will die having watched three million advertisements, with one-third of them from influencers! Are we not aware of the havoc these can wreak on our peace of mind? While these social-media influencers whisper to us old fairytales of "not doing it for the money," we are left materialistically unfulfilled and not present during our interactions with friends and family. Instead, if we choose to ignore them, we can be satisfied with what we have in the present. If you ask any rational person, they will tell you that social-media influencers, viewed in this regard, are best left ignored.

Excellent use of a statistic to support your point.

Good use of a structure, linking back to the motion.

"materialistically unfulfilled" is a good use of language.



Good point, but try to link it more to the motion.

Not only that, but their lifestyles are not real! While the Kardashians rent their mansion in Beverly Hills with million-dollar plastic surgery, our only option is to gape in awe and scapegoat ourselves for not keeping up with them! Yet it seems to be normalised! It is normal to have body dysmorphia! It is normal to have eating disorders! And above all, it is somehow morally acceptable to feed into the opposition's delusions while young girls are starving themselves to death for an "hourglass body"? These toxic social-media influencers are best left ignored, rather than engaged with, to avoid their egregious influence on others' self-esteem spreading throughout others' algorithms. Because the truth is, when we push your deadly agenda further, my dear opposition, we are complacent in the increase in suicide rates, eating disorders, depression, anxiety, the list goes as long as our social media feeds! For the sake of the people, propose this motion.

This is a strong point, but consider adding a personal anecdote to make it more compelling.

Use topic sentences to link back to the question.

"egregious influence" is a good use of language.

However, if you still are not convinced, it is worth acknowledging what algorithms push onto your feed. Algorithms reward outrage. If these algorithms reward the most outrage, is it that, while the opposition are living in a fantasy world of their own — I too am a victim. Constant anger from extremist voices — like the chauvinists Andrew Tate, Nick Fuentes, or even Charlie Kirk — incite violence and hate speech as long as we are not ignoring them. These views are becoming increasingly more normalised, according to the New York Times, with a two-hundred percent increase in racist comments on social media sites. This outrage is outrageous! As the opposition promotes exposure to these views, more and more people, especially adolescents, are exposed to this "manosphere" and crystallise extremist notions at such a young age! Unlike the opposition, we wholeheartedly conceive that social-media influencers are best left ignored, for our children, our politics, our souls.

Good use of a news source to support your point.

The paragraph is coherent, but the link to the motion could be stronger.

"This outrage is outrageous!" is a nice use of repetition.

Likewise, influencers are catalysts not just for extremism, but also misinformation. When misinformation comes from a voice we are exposed to and believe frequently, we are much more likely to conceive it as fact; it goes without saying that insidious misinformation is the most deadly. For instance, when Donald Trump — who is also a social-media influencer — drilled into the MAGA movement that the 2020 election was "rigged," this sparked

This is a good point, but it needs to be developed further.

Use linking phrases to connect this paragraph to the previous one.

"insidious misinformation" is a good use of language.

the atrocities of January 6, when hundreds stormed the Capitol. When we foster the outlook that influencers should be ignored, we are also resisting the lies they administer through our feeds. Moreover, raw milk is also a recurring item among influencers' diets, namely among Erling Haaland's. Nonetheless, they disregard the fact that not everyone has the immunity to it, and that it can be fatal. These are our lives that the opposition is toying with! Whether it be misinformed terrorism of our people or our health, the opposition does not have our best interests in mind! Ultimately, these figures are false authorities and are best ignored for this reason.

Good use of examples, but explain them more.

Ensure that the connection to the motion is clear.

"These are our lives that the opposition is toying with!" is a good use of language.

I would now like to address the opposition's fallacy. In an earlier speech, they claimed influencers are beneficial for democracy through pushing salient voices onto a global stage directly through engagement, namely for example Greta Thunberg or Malala Yousafzai. But as we have elucidated time and time again, extremism far outweighs the actions these figures accomplish. Also, social-media algorithms incentivise anger, not benevolence, as it fosters more engagement. Moreover, in retaliation, crucial "influencers" can still exist without social media, such as Gandhi, Martin Luther King Jr, or Nelson Mandela! Social media and social change are not mutually exclusive, and there is no reason for us to continue engaging with social-media influencers.

Good rebuttal of the opposition's points.

The paragraph is coherent and well-structured.

"extremism far outweighs" is a good use of language.

Good refutation of the opposition's points.

Ladies and gentlemen, to conclude, we must firmly propose the motion that "social-media influencers are best left ignored." The evidence is unequivocal: influencers perturb the peace of mind through materialism, unattainable standards, extremism and lies. If we conceive the opposition's fallacies, it is only a matter of time before we exacerbate this issue, because they are fundamentally misunderstanding what social-media "influencers" aren't truly "social." After all, "there is no such thing as social media, there is only unsocial media." This motion, we must propose. Thank you.

The conclusion is strong and summarises the main points well.

"influencers perturb the peace of mind" is a good use of language.

H1

Grade Calculation

Total Score Calculation

Purpose: 28/30



Coherence: 28/30

Mechanics: 10/10

Language: 28/30

Final Mark: 94/100 (94%)

Estimated Grade: This is an estimated grade. Pulc is often a harsh marker and sometimes makes mistakes. Always rely on your teacher's grade and feedback first. For some FAQs about estimated grades, see .

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